

# Global Corporate Travel & Expense Policy

Standard Operating Procedures and Guidelines

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**Applicability:** All Global Employees, Contractors, and Affiliates

# Table of Contents

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**1.0 Introduction and Objectives**

**2.0 Roles and Responsibilities**

**3.0 Pre-Trip Authorization**

**4.0 Booking Procedures**

**5.0 Air Travel Policy**

**6.0 Accommodation Policy**

**7.0 Ground Transportation**

**8.0 Meals, Incidentals, and Entertainment**

**9.0 Payment Methods and Corporate Cards**

**10.0 Expense Reporting and Reimbursement**

**11.0 International Travel Requirements**

**12.0 Travel Risk Management & Duty of Care**

**13.0 Bleisure (Business + Leisure) Travel**

**14.0 Sustainable Travel Initiatives**

**15.0 Non-Reimbursable Expenses**

**16.0 Policy Compliance and Violations**

**Appendix A: Global City Tier Definitions**

**Appendix B: Daily Allowance (Per Diem) Rates**

**Appendix C: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)**

## 1.0 Introduction and Objectives

### 1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this Global Corporate Travel & Expense Policy (the "Policy") is to establish the standards, guidelines, and procedures for employees incurring business travel and entertainment expenses on behalf of the Company. This document ensures that travel is conducted safely, efficiently, and in a fiscally responsible manner.

This Policy is designed to balance the Company's need to control travel expenses with the necessity of providing travelers with a safe, comfortable, and productive travel experience.

### 1.2 Scope

This Policy applies to all full-time, part-time, and temporary employees, as well as contractors, consultants, board members, and interns (collectively referred to as "Travelers") who travel on company business or incur business entertainment expenses, regardless of their location, department, or level within the organization.

### 1.3 Guiding Principles

The Company operates its travel program based on the following core principles:

- **Safety First:** The health, safety, and security of our employees is the primary consideration for any business travel.
- **Fiscal Responsibility:** Travelers are expected to spend Company funds prudently, ensuring the Company receives the best possible value.
- **Sustainability:** The Company is committed to reducing the environmental impact of corporate travel. Employees are encouraged to make eco-friendly travel choices.
- **Integrity and Compliance:** All expense reports must reflect genuine business expenses and strictly adhere to corporate and legal regulatory requirements (including anti-bribery and corruption laws).

## 2.0 Roles and Responsibilities

### 2.1 The Traveler

The individual traveling on Company business is responsible for:

- Understanding and adhering to all guidelines outlined in this Policy.
- Obtaining proper pre-trip authorization before making any travel arrangements or incurring expenses.
- Ensuring all personal travel documents (e.g., passports, visas, driver's licenses) are valid and up to date.
- Booking all travel through the Company's designated Travel Management Company (TMC) and preferred booking tool.
- Submitting accurate, itemized expense reports with required receipts within the stipulated timeframe.
- Promptly canceling any unneeded reservations to avoid no-show penalties.

### 2.2 The Approving Manager

Managers who approve travel and expenses are responsible for:

- Verifying the business necessity of the proposed travel.
- Ensuring the proposed travel aligns with the department's allocated budget.
- Reviewing expense reports thoroughly to confirm compliance with this Policy prior to approval.
- Identifying and questioning any unusual, excessive, or non-compliant expenses.

### 2.3 Travel Management Company (TMC)

The designated TMC is responsible for:

- Providing travelers with the lowest logical fares within Policy parameters.
- Providing 24/7 emergency support and travel assistance.
- Tracking unused tickets and applying them to future travel.
- Enforcing policy limits at the point of sale.

## 3.0 Pre-Trip Authorization

Pre-trip approval is a critical component of travel risk management and cost control. Travelers must obtain explicit approval from their direct manager prior to booking any travel.

### 3.1 Domestic Travel

For domestic travel within the employee's home country, verbal or written (email) approval from the direct manager is sufficient, provided the total estimated cost of the trip does not exceed \$2,500. For trips exceeding this amount, formal approval via the travel management system is required.

### 3.2 International Travel

All international travel requires formal pre-approval through the Company's travel management platform, regardless of the estimated cost. International travel requests are routed to:

1. The Traveler's Direct Manager
2. The Department Head or VP
3. The Global Security Team (if the destination is designated as high-risk)

#### Important Lead Time

International travel requests should be submitted at least twenty-one (21) days in advance to allow sufficient time for visa processing, security briefings, and the acquisition of the lowest logical airfare.

## 4.0 Booking Procedures

### 4.1 Preferred Booking Channels

All commercial air, hotel, and car rental reservations must be booked exclusively through the Company's designated TMC or the online corporate booking tool. Booking outside these approved

channels (e.g., directly on airline websites, via online travel agencies like Expedia or Booking.com) is strictly prohibited unless specifically exempted by the Global Travel Manager.

Booking through the TMC ensures:

- Company negotiated rates and discounts are applied.
- The Company can fulfill its Duty of Care obligations by tracking traveler locations during emergencies.
- Unused ticket credits are automatically tracked and reused.
- Travel itineraries are seamlessly integrated into the expense management system.

## 5.0 Air Travel Policy

### 5.1 Advance Booking Requirement

Airfare typically increases as the departure date approaches. Travelers must book flights at least **fourteen (14) days** in advance for domestic travel and **twenty-one (21) days** in advance for international travel. Trips booked within 7 days of departure require VP-level approval.

### 5.2 Lowest Logical Airfare (LLA)

Travelers must accept the Lowest Logical Airfare. LLA is defined as the lowest fare available at the time of booking that meets the following criteria:

- Departure or arrival time is within two (2) hours of the requested time.
- The flight requires no more than one connection (for domestic flights) or two connections (for long-haul international flights).
- The connection time does not exceed three (3) hours.
- The fare includes reasonable baggage allowances.

### 5.3 Class of Service Guidelines

The allowable class of service is determined by the continuous scheduled flight duration (excluding layovers).

| Flight Duration     | Standard Travelers           | Vice Presidents & Above |
|---------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Under 4 hours       | Economy Class                | Economy Class           |
| 4 to 8 hours        | Premium Economy              | Business Class          |
| Over 8 hours        | Business Class               | Business Class          |
| Red-Eye / Overnight | Business Class (if >6 hours) | Business Class          |

## 5.4 Upgrades

Travelers may use personal frequent flyer miles, upgrade certificates, or personal funds to upgrade their class of service. The Company will not reimburse for paid upgrades, preferred seating fees, or administrative fees associated with processing mileage upgrades. If an upgrade results in additional baggage fees, those fees will not be reimbursed.

## 5.5 Airline Loyalty Programs

Travelers may retain frequent flyer miles and status benefits earned while traveling on Company business. However, travelers must not select higher-priced flights or sub-optimal routing solely to accumulate miles on a preferred airline.

## 5.6 Baggage Fees

The Company will reimburse the cost of one (1) checked bag for trips up to five (5) days, and two (2) checked bags for trips exceeding five (5) days or trips requiring specific equipment or materials. Excess baggage fees for personal items are the responsibility of the traveler.

## 5.7 Airport Lounges

Annual memberships to airline clubs or independent airport lounges are generally not reimbursable. Exception: Employees who are required to travel more than 100,000 miles or 50 segments per year may be reimbursed for one (1) standard lounge membership, subject to VP approval.

## **6.0 Accommodation Policy**

### **6.1 Preferred Hotels**

The Company has negotiated corporate rates with several major hotel chains globally. Travelers must utilize these preferred properties whenever available. The online booking tool is configured to display preferred hotels first.

### **6.2 Room Type and Rate Limits**

Travelers are expected to book standard, single-occupancy rooms. Suites, executive floor rooms, or premium view rooms are not reimbursable unless the traveler receives a complimentary upgrade from the hotel. The nightly room rate (excluding taxes) must not exceed the maximum allowable caps set for the destination city tier (See Appendix A and B).

### **6.3 Hotel Cancellations and No-Shows**

Travelers are responsible for canceling hotel reservations prior to the hotel's cancellation deadline (typically 24-48 hours before check-in) to avoid penalty fees. "No-show" charges will not be reimbursed by the Company unless the failure to cancel was due to an emergency or severe business disruption outside the traveler's control.

### **6.4 Alternative Accommodations (Airbnb, VRBO)**

The use of peer-to-peer lodging platforms like Airbnb or VRBO is permitted for extended stays (exceeding 7 nights) or in remote locations where traditional commercial lodging is unavailable. However, these bookings must be pre-approved, as they often lack the standard security, fire safety, and liability protections of commercial hotels.

### **6.5 Staying with Family or Friends**

Travelers may choose to stay with family or friends instead of a commercial hotel. In such cases, the Company will reimburse the traveler for a host gift (e.g., flowers, a modest dinner, or a gift basket) up to a maximum value of \$75 per stay. Cash payments to hosts are strictly prohibited.



## 7.0 Ground Transportation

### 7.1 Rental Cars

Rental cars should only be used when they are more cost-effective or efficient than public transportation, taxis, or rideshare services. Standard rules for rental cars include:

- **Class:** Intermediate/Mid-size cars are the standard category. Full-size cars or SUVs are permitted only when 3 or more employees are traveling together, or when carrying substantial company equipment.
- **Fuel:** Travelers must decline the pre-paid fuel option from the rental agency. Cars must be refueled prior to return.
- **Preferred Vendors:** Use only preferred rental car vendors as designated in the booking tool to ensure negotiated rates and included insurance coverages apply.

### 7.2 Rental Car Insurance

For domestic rentals (within the home country), the Company provides primary insurance coverage. Travelers must **decline** all optional insurance offerings (Collision Damage Waiver, Liability, Personal Effects coverage) at the rental counter. For international rentals, travelers should **accept** standard liability and collision coverage, as local laws and corporate coverages vary.

### 7.3 Taxis and Rideshares (Uber, Lyft)

Taxis and rideshare services are approved for transportation between airports, hotels, and business locations. Travelers are encouraged to use standard rideshare options (e.g., UberX, standard Lyft) rather than premium services (Uber Black, Lyft Lux) unless traveling with clients or executives.

### 7.4 Personal Vehicles

Employees may use their personal vehicles for business travel if it is more cost-effective than flying or renting a car. The Company reimburses mileage at the standard government rate (e.g., IRS rate in the US). This mileage allowance is intended to cover fuel, maintenance, insurance, and depreciation. Normal commuting mileage from the employee's home to their primary office is not reimbursable.

## 8.0 Meals, Incidentals, and Entertainment

### 8.1 Individual Travel Meals

The Company will reimburse travelers for reasonable meal expenses incurred while traveling on company business. The company utilizes a **Per Diem / Daily Allowance** model based on the destination city tier (See Appendix B). Travelers do not need to submit itemized receipts for individual meals if claiming the standard per diem, provided the travel includes an overnight stay.

If a traveler is attending a conference or flight where a meal is provided, the daily per diem should be reduced by the appropriate proportion (e.g., 20% for breakfast, 30% for lunch, 50% for dinner).

### 8.2 Business Entertainment and Client Meals

Business entertainment expenses are incurred when a traveler hosts clients, prospects, or external partners for business purposes. These are not subject to standard per diem caps, but must be "reasonable and customary."

#### Client Meal Documentation

For all business entertainment meals, the expense report **MUST** include: an itemized receipt, the names and titles of all attendees, the affiliated company, and a specific description of the business purpose/topics discussed.

### 8.3 Alcohol Consumption

The Company will reimburse moderate alcohol consumption during business entertainment or client meals. As a guideline, this should not exceed two standard drinks per person. The cost of alcohol must be reasonable and appropriate for the occasion. Expensive bottles of wine or excessive rounds of drinks will be flagged and may be denied reimbursement.

### 8.4 Tipping

Reasonable tips and gratuities are reimbursable. Guidelines include: 15-20% for meals and taxis, \$1-\$2 per bag for porters, and \$2-\$5 per day for hotel housekeeping.

## 9.0 Payment Methods and Corporate Cards

### 9.1 Corporate Credit Cards

Employees who travel more than twice a year or regularly incur business expenses will be issued a corporate credit card. The corporate card is the mandatory payment method for all business travel expenses (airfare, hotel, car rental, meals). The use of personal credit cards for primary business travel expenses is strongly discouraged.

### 9.2 Personal Use of Corporate Cards

The corporate credit card is for business use only. Personal expenses must never be charged to the corporate card. If a personal expense is accidentally charged to the card, the employee must flag it as "Personal" in the expense system and immediately remit payment to the Company to clear the balance.

### 9.3 Cash Advances

Cash advances are generally not permitted, as the corporate card should cover most expenses. Exceptions may be made for travel to countries with primarily cash-based economies, subject to VP Finance approval. Advances must be reconciled within 10 days of returning from the trip.

## 10.0 Expense Reporting and Reimbursement

### 10.1 Timeliness of Submission

Expense reports must be submitted within **thirty (30) days** of the completion of the trip or the date the expense was incurred. Late submissions create accounting challenges and may result in delayed reimbursements or tax implications.

Corporate card transactions that remain unexpensed for more than 60 days will result in the suspension of the corporate card. Transactions unexpensed after 90 days may be deducted from the employee's payroll, subject to local labor laws.

## 10.2 Receipt Requirements

Itemized receipts are required for all expenses exceeding \$25.00 USD (or local equivalent). Credit card terminal slips that show only the total amount are not acceptable as they do not itemize the goods or services purchased.

## 10.3 Currency Conversion

For corporate card transactions, the exchange rate applied by the credit card issuer will be accepted. For out-of-pocket expenses in foreign currencies, the expense management system will automatically calculate the exchange rate based on the date of the transaction.

# 11.0 International Travel Requirements

## 11.1 Passports and Visas

Employees traveling internationally must possess a passport valid for at least six (6) months beyond the planned return date. The Company will reimburse the cost of obtaining or renewing a passport if the employee is required to travel internationally for business. Visa application fees and expedited processing fees required for business travel are fully reimbursable.

## 11.2 Vaccinations and Medical Preventatives

The Company will reimburse the cost of necessary vaccinations, preventative medications (e.g., anti-malarial pills), and required medical tests (e.g., PCR tests) required for entry into a destination country.

## 11.3 International Telecommunications

Employees traveling internationally should consult with the IT department prior to departure to activate an international roaming plan on their corporate mobile device. The purchase of temporary international SIM cards or portable Wi-Fi hotspots is reimbursable if an international plan cannot be activated.

## 12.0 Travel Risk Management & Duty of Care

### 12.1 Traveler Tracking

Because the Company has a moral and legal Duty of Care to its employees, all travel must be booked through the approved TMC to ensure traveler itineraries are captured in the global tracking system. In the event of a natural disaster, political unrest, or security incident, this allows the Global Security team to quickly locate and assist employees.

### 12.2 High-Risk Destinations

Travel to countries or regions designated as "High Risk" by the Company's security provider requires special authorization from the Chief Risk Officer. Travelers to these areas will receive a pre-trip security briefing and may be provided with specialized security personnel, secure ground transportation, and specific communications protocols.

### 12.3 Medical Emergencies Abroad

The Company provides comprehensive travel medical insurance and emergency evacuation coverage for all employees traveling outside their home country. Travelers must carry the emergency contact card provided by the HR/Travel department at all times.

## 13.0 Bleisure (Business + Leisure) Travel

The Company recognizes that employees may wish to combine personal time with business trips. This is permissible under the following strict conditions:

- The business purpose of the trip must be the primary reason for travel.
- The addition of personal days must not result in any incremental cost to the Company. For example, if extending the stay results in a higher airfare, the employee must pay the difference.
- The Company's travel insurance and Duty of Care obligations do not extend to the personal portion of the trip.
- All expenses incurred during the personal days (hotel, meals, transport) are strictly the responsibility of the employee.

## 13.1 Companion Travel

Family members or companions may accompany employees on business trips at the employee's own expense. The Company will not reimburse any travel, lodging, or meal costs for companions. The presence of a companion must not interfere with the business purpose of the trip.

## 14.0 Sustainable Travel Initiatives

As part of our commitment to environmental sustainability, employees are encouraged to minimize their carbon footprint while traveling:

- **Evaluate the Need:** Before booking, consider if the business objectives can be achieved via video conferencing or virtual meetings.
- **Direct Flights:** When possible, book direct flights as takeoffs and landings account for the largest portion of aviation emissions.
- **Rail vs. Air:** For journeys under 300 miles (500 km), travelers are strongly encouraged to use high-speed rail instead of air travel.
- **Eco-Friendly Hotels:** Prefer hotels that have recognized green certifications or demonstrated sustainability practices (e.g., removing single-use plastics, energy-efficient operations).
- **Ground Transport:** Opt for public transit, hybrid/electric rental cars, or walking/biking when feasible.

## 15.0 Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The following expenses are strictly personal and will NOT be reimbursed by the Company under any circumstances:

- |                                           |                                               |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| • Airline club dues (unless exempted)     | • In-room movies or entertainment             |
| • Babysitting or pet-boarding fees        | • Loss or theft of personal funds or property |
| • Barbers, hairdressers, or spa services  | • Magazines, books, or personal reading       |
| • Clothing or luggage purchases           | • Mini-bar purchases                          |
| • Corporate card late fees or interest    | • Optional travel insurance                   |
| • Fines for traffic or parking violations | • Personal credit card annual fees            |

- Personal grooming items
- Souvenirs or personal gifts
- Shoeshine services
- Upgrades to air, hotel, or car rentals

## 16.0 Policy Compliance and Violations

Compliance with this policy is mandatory. The Finance and Internal Audit teams conduct regular, automated, and manual audits of travel expenses. Non-compliance, including the submission of fraudulent expenses, falsified receipts, or repeated violations of booking channels, may result in:

- Delay or denial of expense reimbursement.
- Suspension or permanent revocation of corporate credit card privileges.
- Formal disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.
- Civil or criminal prosecution in cases of severe fraud or embezzlement.

## Appendix A: Global City Tier Definitions

To ensure fair and reasonable accommodation and meal limits, destinations are categorized into Tiers based on the local cost of living and average business travel costs.

| Tier Category            | Description                                                              | Example Cities                                                                                     |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier 1 (Premium)</b>  | Global financial centers and exceptionally high-cost metropolitan areas. | New York, London, Tokyo, San Francisco, Zurich, Geneva, Hong Kong, Singapore.                      |
| <b>Tier 2 (High)</b>     | Major international capitals and high-cost regional hubs.                | Paris, Sydney, Los Angeles, Washington D.C., Boston, Chicago, Frankfurt, Dubai, Seoul.             |
| <b>Tier 3 (Standard)</b> | Standard domestic and international business destinations.               | Atlanta, Dallas, Berlin, Madrid, Rome, Toronto, Melbourne, Mumbai, São Paulo.                      |
| <b>Tier 4 (Economy)</b>  | Secondary cities, developing regions, and rural areas.                   | Most secondary US cities, standard locations in Latin America, Southeast Asia, and Eastern Europe. |

## Appendix B: Daily Allowance & Accommodation Caps

The following table outlines the maximum allowable daily rates for accommodation (excluding taxes/fees) and the Daily Per Diem allowance for meals and incidentals. Rates are displayed in USD equivalents.



| Destination Tier  | Max Hotel Rate (Nightly) | Meals & Incidentals (Per Diem) | Total Maximum Daily Spend |
|-------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Tier 1 (Premium)  | \$400 USD                | \$150 USD                      | \$550 USD                 |
| Tier 2 (High)     | \$275 USD                | \$110 USD                      | \$385 USD                 |
| Tier 3 (Standard) | \$200 USD                | \$80 USD                       | \$280 USD                 |
| Tier 4 (Economy)  | \$150 USD                | \$60 USD                       | \$210 USD                 |

### Seasonal Surcharges

During major industry conferences, city-wide events, or peak tourist seasons, hotel rates may exceed the caps listed above. In such cases, travelers must obtain documented approval from their manager prior to booking, clearly stating the reason for the overage.

## Appendix C: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

### Q: What if I have dietary restrictions and need to purchase special, more expensive meals?

A: The Per Diem limits are designed to accommodate a wide variety of dietary needs. If your specific medical or religious dietary requirements consistently cause you to exceed the daily allowance, please discuss this with your manager for a pre-approved exception.

**Q: My flight was delayed 6 hours. Can I expense a meal at the airport?**

A: Yes. If you are experiencing a significant travel delay, you may expense reasonable food and beverage costs incurred at the airport. This should be claimed as part of your daily Per Diem allowance.

**Q: Can I use my personal credit card to get travel reward points?**

A: No. If you have been issued a corporate credit card, you must use it for all major travel expenses (air, hotel, car). The use of personal cards for primary business expenses to accrue points is a direct violation of policy.

**Q: I am extending my business trip for a weekend vacation. Can I book a single round-trip flight?**

A: Yes, you can book a single round-trip flight. However, you must document the cost of a standard round-trip flight (for the business dates only) at the time of booking. If the flight including your personal dates is more expensive, you must reimburse the Company for the difference.

**Q: I lost my receipt for a \$45 dinner. What should I do?**

A: If you are claiming the standard Per Diem, no receipt is required. If this was a business entertainment/client meal, you must contact the vendor to obtain a duplicate receipt. If a duplicate cannot be obtained, you must submit a "Missing Receipt Affidavit" signed by your manager, though this should be a rare exception.

**Q: Can I book an Airbnb if it's cheaper than the preferred hotel?**

A: Generally, no. While it may appear cheaper, booking outside the approved channels breaks our Duty of Care tracking and bypasses our negotiated liability protections. Exceptions require VP approval.